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Focus Groups

Feb 18th 2026

Why, what and when....

Target

- Understanding of how young users perceive telco advertising and brands, how they choose providers, and what drives switching or loyalty.
- Identifying opportunities to optimize A1's brand positioning and communication for young target groups.

4 Focus Groups

High Value Voice Customers (A1, Magenta, Drei)
18-24y.o.
25-29y.o.

Low Value Voice Customers (Hot, spusu, yesss!....)
18-24y.o.
25-29y.o.

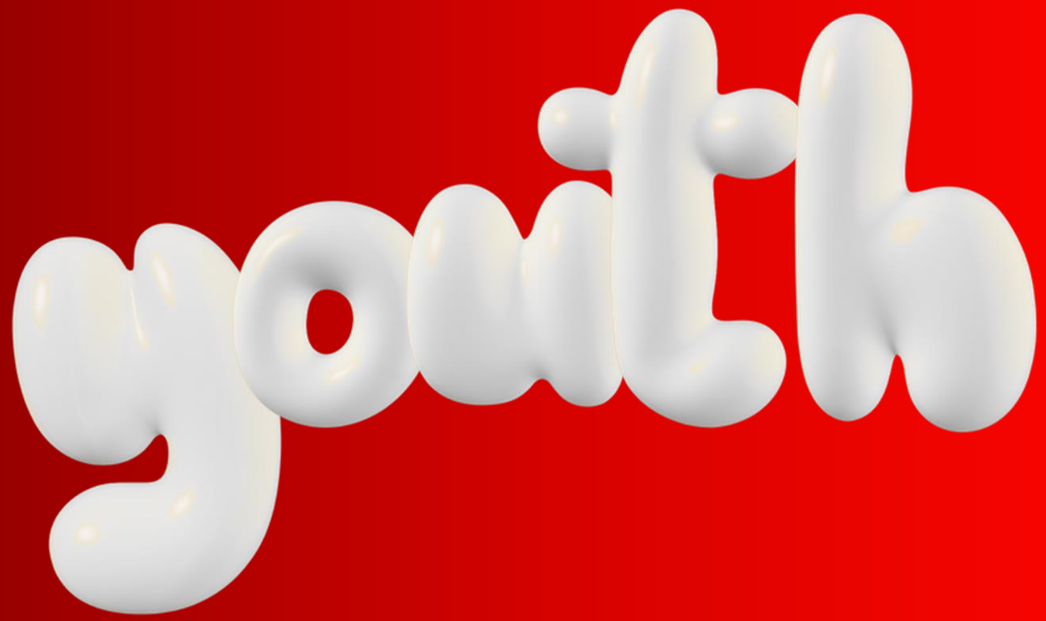
Vienna; Mixed: Gender, Occupation/Student, Migration Background

Institute

Integral

Fieldwork

20th & 22nd Jan



The next 25 Minutes....

1. Intro Sinus Milieus
2. Advertising Perception
3. Brand Images
4. Decision Process & Switching
5. Netquality, Service & Added Value
6. (Final Perspective of the Participants)
7. Key Findings & Recommendations

Draft for internal discussion

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A1

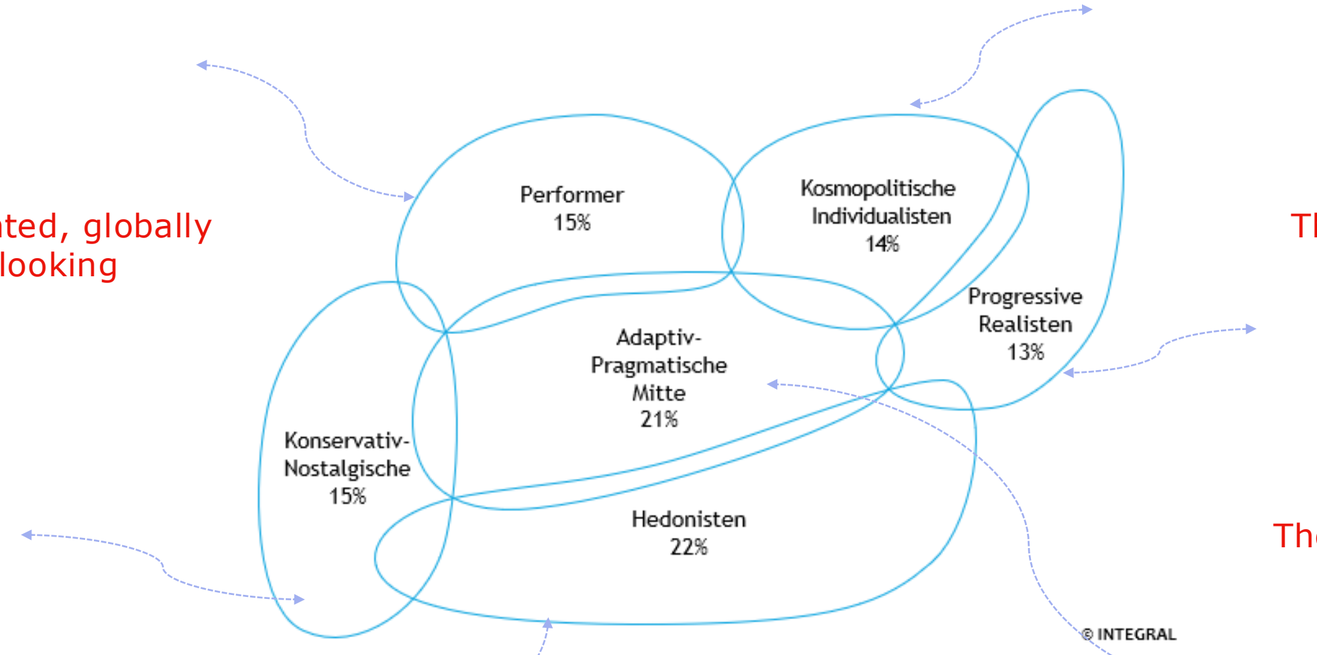
1. A short glimpse into Sinus Milieus

Sinus-Milieus in Austria – Youth-Focused (-29 y.o.)

Sinus Milieus - Short characteristics

The achievement-oriented, globally oriented, and forward-looking

The ambitious lifestyle avant-garde



The drivers of social change

The family- and home-oriented down-to-earth people

The adaptable, benefit-focused mainstream

The mainstream rejecters in search of fun and consumption

Quelle/ Copyright: INTEGRAL Markt- und Meinungsforschung

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2. Advertising Perception

Participants most frequently recall advertising from retail and FMCG brands.

Advertising recalled spontaneously

Retail and FMCG-brands

1

HOFER
clever
Red Bull
LIDL
XXXLutz

Finance & digital services

2

NordVPN
TRADE REPUBLIC
ERSTE
Revolut

Especially LVV-customers

Energy & utilities

3

oekostrom AG
100% ÖKO, 100% FAIR

Others

4

durex
TUI
SEAT
ASPIRIN
AMS
Arbeitsmarktservice Österreich

Font size: Qualitative interpretation of relevance

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January 2026

Advertising recall is driven by unavoidable exposure on major channels and contextual relevance on digital platforms.

Where participants reported seeing the advertising

Relevance

Social media (feeds)	• Especially Instagram or TikTok • described as omnipresent or “hidden” advertising
Youtube (Especially LVV customers)	• very prominently, influencer sponsorships • Pre-roll ads
TV & Radio	• less frequently, but still recalled for repetitive or jingle-based campaigns
Out-of-home (Especially HVV customers)	• posters in the subway • large-scale installations • roadside billboards
Print	• Leaflets • free newspapers, district papers (e.g. spusu ads)

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January 2026

Entertainment and distinctiveness drive recall – overload kills it.

Why the advertising stays in mind

Positive factors

- **"Catchy"** – mainly for music, jingles, or unexpected visuals (e.g. Clever, Ökostrom, Red Bull)
- **"Funny / entertaining"** – especially for YouTube ads or influencer-read sponsorships
- **"Present everywhere / very often"** – repetition as a key driver of recall; hard to avoid
- **"Color"** – esp. Magenta
- **"Appetizing"** – food advertising - sensory reaction
- **"Creative / eye-catching"** – large-scale outdoor installations (e.g. Post)
- **"interest-oriented"** – e.g. gaming, NBA

Negative factors

- **"annoying"** – when ads are perceived as overplayed
- **"exhausting"** – especially price-heavy or offer-driven messages

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January 2026

Magenta shows the strongest recall, A1 recall is average and more technically coded.

Provider	Advertising recall	What is remembered?	Character
Magenta	• **Highest recall** • In all target groups but strongest with clients of A1/ Magenta/ Drei	• Poster ads / Out-of-home • Online commercials • Some: radio ads	• Visually striking (color, look) • Campaign-unspecific(few claims, few offers) • High recognition, shallow content → **Top of mind due to visibility, not message**
A1	• **Average recall** • Mainly with clients of A1/ Magenta/ Drei	• TV ads, esp.: fibre broadband • Poster ads • Occasional online spots • Occasional: A1 e-sport league	• More thematic than specific • Emotionally calmer, less conspicuous • Memory of "A1 does advertising," not much specific content → **present, but less memorable**
3	• **Low recall**	• Hardly any specific advertising • Isolated cases: Older campaigns, historical Orange phase	• Blurry • Often explicit: "I hardly see Drei advertising" → **very low classic advertising recall**

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Recall for yesss! is rather low. High visibility of spusu at events.

Provider	Advertising recall	What is remembered?	Character
HoT HOFER TELEKOM	• **Low, but selective recall** • Mainly clients of LVV providers	• Radio spots • Concrete offers (9,99€, more data) • POS at Hofer	• Clear content • Strongly price-driven • No emotional charge → **low reach, but high content recall**
spusu	• **Low recall of classical advertising** • Contextual brand presence	• Classical advertising is hardly remembered • Very visible on events and in student's circles (student's goodie bags) or sports	→ **Recall is not driven by classic advertising but shaped by physical presence in student-related environments** such as universities and events. This creates a strong contextual association, particularly among students.
yesss! macht mein Leben yessser	• **Low recall**	• Occasional: logo, colour • Individual nomination: Radio spot with claim • No concrete offers	• Visual, not contextual • Low depth • Sometimes explicit: "I don't even know, if they do advertising." → **Low reach**
bob	• **Low recall** • Slightly negative perception	• Occasional: "Annoying advertising" • No concrete contents or offers	• Unspecific • More distracting than motivating • No clear message stuck in mind → **Low and rather negative recall**

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3. Brand Images

HVV customers favor brands that feel reliable, familiar and easy to live with. LVV customers favor brands that deliver smart value, functionality and everyday relevance.

HVV provider customers

I think **Apple** is pretty good. I think the quality is quite high. Considering what Apple phones actually cost, I think they deliver very good performance and are relatively easy and convenient to use.

Performer

In sports, especially for football, **Adidas and Nike** have been so prominent since I was little, also because the top players advertise for them.

Prog. Realisten

I also shop at **Zara**, especially because of Instagram. I always see bloggers promoting new clothes, and that influences me too

Kosmopol. Ind.

LVV provider customers

[DM-labels] Because it's not too expensive, it suits me well, and I like using it.

Adap.-Prag. Mitte

[Oppo] They're mostly mid-range phones, but they can really keep up with any flagship phone at a reasonable price.

Hedonisten

[**Red Bull]** Especially all the extreme sports stuff they do. Yeah, it's really entertaining.

Kosmopol. Ind.

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A1 is seen as competent and trustworthy but limited emotional pull for price-focused users.

Core brand image

- Reliable, established
- Technically strong
- Austrian
- Trustworthy but conservative

Differences between target groups

- **HVV customers:** A1 represents security, stability and quality – brand seen as a “safe choice”.
- **LVV customers:** A1 perceived as too expensive for actual needs. Image respected, but not attractive.

Relevance by Sinus Youth-Milieus

- **High:** Performer & Konservativ-Nostalgische
- **Medium:** Kosmopolitische Individualisten & Adaptiv-Pr. Mitte
  Low: Progressive Realisten & Hedonisten

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Magenta is perceived as a modern lifestyle brand with high visibility.

Core brand image

- Highly visible, modern, dynamic, “everywhere”
- Entertainment oriented (TV, bundles)
- Sometimes perceived as complex or overwhelming

Differences between target groups

- **HVV customers:** see Magenta as a strong and modern brand. Image is relevant, even if not always personal fitting.
- **LVV customers:** perceive Magenta as unnecessarily overfeatured. Image is acknowledged, but low personal relevance.

Relevance by Sinus Youth-Milieus

- **High:** Adaptiv-Pragmatische Mitte & Kons.-Nostalgische
- **Medium:** Performer & Kosmopolitische Individualisten
- **Low:** Progressive Realisten & Hedonisten

T Magenta

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Drei image shows low differentiation and low relevance across target groups.

Core brand image

- Weakly defined
- Reduced to devices and shops
- Low emotional attachment, unclear positioning

Differences between target groups

- **HVV customers:** see Drei as less premium and less relevant, compared to A1 and Magenta.
- **LVV customers:** largely indifferent, no strong positive or negative image.

Relevance by Sinus Youth-Milieus

- **High:** -
- **Medium:** Konservativ-Nostalgische
- **Low:** Performer, Kosmopolitische Individualisten, Progressive Realisten, Adaptiv-Pragmatische Mitte, Hedonisten

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spusu is seen as a brand that values authenticity and proximity over classical advertising.

Core brand image

- Low priced
- Transparent & fair, uncomplicated
- Student-oriented
- Service-friendly

Differences between target groups

- **HVV customers:** perceive spusu as “not for me” but credible.
- **LVV customers:** high trust in the brand, strong alignment with personal mindset.

Relevance by Sinus Youth-Milieus

- **High:** Progressive Realisten & Hedonisten
- **Medium:** Kosmopolitische Individualisten
- **Low:** Performer, Adaptiv-Pragmatische Mitte, Konservativ-Nostalgische

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yesss! is perceived as a functional low-cost provider rather than a lifestyle brand.

Core brand image

- Inexpensive to low-end
- Functional & simple
- No strong emotional profile, low visual appeal

Differences between target groups

- **HVV customers:** low engagement, neutral to negative perception.
- **LVV customers:** accepted as a rational alternative. Valued for A1 network association.

Relevance by Sinus Youth-Milieus

- **High: Hedonisten**
- **Medium:** Performer, Kosmopolitische Individualisten
- **Low:** Progressive Realisten, Adaptiv-Pragmatische Mitte, Konservativ-Nostalgische

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Youth segments differ in how brand relevance is created – from trust and stability to autonomy and independence.

Brand relevance mechanisms

Flexibility & fairness

Value for money

Image & lifestyle

Social proof

Progress & simplicity

Quality & stability

Youth Milieu mindsets

Premium driven

Performer

- Consistency & excellence outweigh frequent change
- Top-tier network performance and reliability
- Low tolerance for quality compromises

Efficiency driven

Kosmopolitische Individualisten

- Modern, forward-looking brand stories
- Clear, contemporary pricing logic
- Innovation with tangible benefits
- Low switching effort

Socially driven

Progressive Realisten

- Brands are validated by people, not advertising
- Recommendations & peer usage
- Personal experience
- Trust trough familiarity

Image driven

Adaptiv-Pragmatische Mitte

- Modernity & lifestyle create relevance
- Visual idendity & presence
- Cultural fit
- Emotional resonance

Value driven

Konservativ-Nostalgische

- Brands are evaluated, lifestyle aspects play minor role
- Stable performance
- Clear product advantages
- Rational comparison

Autonomy driven

Hedonisten

- Independence matters more than brand power
- Flexibility & control
- Fairness & transparency

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A1's strengths lie in reliability – its challenges in emotional appeal to young people.

	Strengths		Weaknesses	
1	Network quality & reliability; technical edge		Perceived lack of youth-relevance	1
2	Safe choice, low perceived risk	Especially for LVV customers	Too complex	2
3	Comprehensive range of products, everything from a single source		Price perception	3
4	Austrian brand identity		Low emotional appeal, little excitement or inspiration	4

Font size: Qualitative interpretation of relevance

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Illustrative quotes from participants

HVV provider customers

I have to say, when I think about A1 ads, I always get this familiar feeling—it's been around since I was a kid, those family-at-home commercials. I think I saw one again last year. It feels like they always follow the same format.

Adaptiv-Prag.

A1 was an early mover in rolling out glass fiber.

Kosmopol. Ind.

A1 really does have good network quality.

Kon.-Nostalgische

LVV provider customers

I think A1 is really expensive, even though the network is excellent.

Performer

A1 is kind of the standard provider.

Prog. Realisten

I associate A1 more with an older audience.

Prog. Realisten

I feel that if I were to sign a contract with A1 now, I'd have to be very careful and watch out for anything hidden—that's, for me, the biggest weakness.

Hedonisten

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4. Decision Process and Switching

While HVV customers require a strong incentive, LVV customers are more open to switching.

Provider choice

HVV provider customers

- Tend to inherit providers due to **family decisions** rather than active choice.
- Show **low emotional engagement** with brand.
- Are aware that alternatives exist but **delay switching due to perceived hassle**.
- Brand legacy still plays a role, especially regarding network trust.

LVV provider customers

- **High sense of agency** in choosing and evaluating providers.
- Actively compare offers and value **monthly flexibility.**
- Brand attachment is weak, but **satisfaction is high** as long as expectations are met.
- Willing to switch again if conditions improve elsewhere.

Switching triggers & barriers

- Lower price with comparable performance
- Better transparency
- Easier contract management

- Require a **strong incentive** to overcome perceived switching risk & effort.

- Are **structurally more open to switching**, as flexibility is already part of their mindset.

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5. Netquality, Service and Added Value

Network quality is rarely a positive differentiator – but a strong negative trigger when expectations are not met.

HVV customers

Role of Network Quality:
- Central component of trust and security.
- Actively noticed and consciously considered.
- Serves as justification for higher prices and longer commitments

How It Is Interpreted:
- "It must be stable — then I have peace of mind."
- Network quality = insurance against problems
- Symbolizes professionalism, scale, and reliability

Impact on Behavior:
- Poor network quality → strong loss of trust
- Good network quality → strengthens loyalty, reduces willingness to switch
- Little reason to switch as long as quality remains stable

LVV customers

Role of Network Quality:
- Hygiene Factor / Minimum Requirement
- Rarely actively evaluated as long as it works
- Not a reason for emotional attachment

How It Is Interpreted:
- "It just has to work."
- Network quality = functioning infrastructure
- Minimal brand attribution ("the network is just there")

Impact on Behavior:
- Good network quality → no reward or added loyalty
- Poor network quality → immediate justification to switch
- Switching is perceived as low-risk and reversible

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For HVV customers, add-ons strengthen the offer but rarely drive switching. LVV customers want a reduction of costs or effort.

Relevance	HVV customers	LVV customers
	• Bundles (mobile & internet) • Roaming (esp. EU) • Streaming or entertainment extras • Hardware (mainly smartphones)	• Roaming • Transparent, flexible data options • Simple tariff upgrades
	• Cloud or security services • Paid AI services • Points, loyalty programs	• Basic security features • Streaming or entertainment extras • Paid AI services
	• Overly complex benefit systems	• Hardware offers

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7. Key Findings and Recommendations

Recommendations & Implications

Extend the image of “for older or business users” and establish A1 as a real option for young (urban) customers.

1

Visibility where young people already are

- Be seen as part of **young people’s everyday media reality**, not as a distant telco brand.
- Shift visibility towards **Instagram, TikTok and YouTube**
- Increase presence in **student-related environments and events**

2

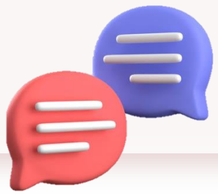
Make youth tariffs visible and credible

- Communicate **youth tariffs** clearly, prominently and repeatedly
- Frame A1 not only as “reliable” but also as **accessible & affordable** for young people

3

Simplicity, flexibility & perceived control

- Emphasize **transparency and flexibility**
- Reduce perceived risk by clearly addressing **“no hidden conditions”**
- **No long-term commitments**
- Stress how **easy switching to A1 is**, as A1 manages everything
- Use **simple language** instead of technical framing



4

Bundles with clear, tangible everyday value

- Strengthen perceived value **without increasing complexity** or confusion.
- Focus on simple, **easy-to-understand bundles**
- Ensure that bundle value is immediately **understandable and relevant** to daily life